

Oil Markets Weekly

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【メール原文】

Oil likely to trade below \$95 as the US backs away from escalation . Eurasia Group flipped its call last week (see: De-escalation likely as US leans toward temporary fix to open strait , 4 August 2026).

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Oil leaking through the Gulf will help keep prices lower

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Escalation in the US-Iran conflict appears less likely, with the US and Iran now slowly moving toward de-escalation and a deal to reopen the strait in the coming weeks.

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About 5 million barrels per day (bpd) are moving through the Strait of Hormuz despite Iranian restrictions, helping to keep prices low and easing the pressure on the US to escalate.

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The impact of these flows is partially offset by the disruption to Saudi oil loadings in the Red Sea, where Houthi attacks have affected loadings from the port of Yanbu.

Oil likely to trade below \$95 as the US backs away from escalation. Eurasia Group flipped its call last week (see: De-escalation likely as US leans toward temporary fix to open strait , 4 August 2026). We now see de-escalation and a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz as likely by mid-September.

Oil markets are pricing in a somewhat more optimistic outlook, with the Brent crude price trading in the mid \$80s. The price is likely to remain in a \$75-\$95 range until a deal is reached, at which point it will fall further, into a \$65-\$75 per barrel range, in anticipation of increased regional flows.

Data suggest about 5 million bpd are getting through the Gulf. As was the case during the war and ceasefire period, Hormuz is not entirely shut. Ship-tracking data suggests that around 5 million bpd are getting out of the waterway.

There are three main channels. First, some tankers pass through Iran's route on the northern end of the strait, having (presumably) obtained permission from Iran beforehand. Second, some tankers proceed through the waterway by "going dark," switching off their transponders to avoid detection (and Iranian attack), before reappearing in the Gulf of Oman and Indian Ocean.

A third group of tankers is also transiting the waterway without detection; but rather than proceed further, these tankers load their crude on to other, waiting tankers in the Gulf of Oman, via ship-to-ship transfers. Ship-tracking data from Kpler suggests the volume of oil exiting the strait in this way is quite large, as much as 2.5 million barrels per day.

Flows out of the Gulf will help keep prices in a lower band and reduce pressure on US to escalate. This success in transiting the strait is likely contributing to the US's decision to back away from escalation. While Iran continues to fire at ships to keep the strait largely closed, it seems disinclined to undertake more aggressive moves. That suggests oil shipments will continue to move through the waterway in the coming weeks, even if flows remain uneven.

Success in Hormuz is partially offset by a slowdown in the Red Sea. Houthi attacks in the Bab al-Mandeb have caused major disruption and have largely halted tanker transit to the Saudi oil port of Yanbu. As a result, Saudi oil exports from Yanbu—the main route for Saudi oil to reach the market—have fallen sharply.

Disruption to Yanbu flows is likely to be temporary, unless the port has been damaged. Exports will likely recover in a few weeks, as empty tankers that normally would have transited via the Bab al-Mandeb transit around Africa to reach Yanbu via the Suez Canal. If the berths at Yanbu have been damaged, or if the Houthis succeed in damaging the East-West pipeline that connects the port to the main Saudi oil fields, loadings could face a longer disruption.

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